

Brooklyn “that is roughly one-eighth the size and double the price of my childhood home.” (New York, city of dreams!) If you inherit your parents’ house and you don’t want to live there immediately (like Eden does), you should sell it. Penty felt awful selling his childhood home, but realistically, he had to consider the upkeep of a house that large and the cost of property taxes.

- ° It’s best not to have siblings. In an interview for this book, Penty said he was lucky to be the sole executor of the will. His parents didn’t have a fortune to begin with, and he didn’t have to split any of it with anyone else or run anything by a sibling before he did it. “No family drama,” he said. (Jesus Christ, what is that like?)
- ° Be prepared for mountains of paperwork. Penty compared it to applying to college: “It’s just a bunch of paperwork and it takes months. You can’t rush it even if you try. Sit down and get through all the paperwork, and pay attention even if the words make your eyes cross.”

GETTING YOUR OWN MORTAL SHIT IN ORDER

What about if *you* die young? I’m 29. It feels like it’s not an option. But then I think about my friend’s father, whose wife died at 31, leaving him with two young daughters. She didn’t have a will or life insurance, which, he said, left a lot of confusion for their family. How could she have known she’d pass away so young? I can’t know either.

Lawyer David Shapiro said if you’re that young, you probably don’t have assets other than your bank account or maybe a car. In that case, he said, name someone as a beneficiary to avoid ambiguity. Maybe a lot of us don’t have assets, but some young people do own homes. I don’t, but I do have a retirement account. At the end of 2017, my accountant, Dan, asked me for a name to put on my retirement account as a beneficiary in case I die. I hadn’t thought about it. I chose my mother for no reason other than I trust her to figure it out. When I told her, she said, “Let’s hope I never have to.”